

WILLIAM S. DAVIS III

Ship Agency & Marine Terminal Development

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SUMMARY

Ship agency and marine terminal professional with thirty years on the U.S. Atlantic and Gulf Coasts. At Host (2006–2025), a member of the small core team that took the company from family business to equity-backed firm: integrating acquired agencies, opening new offices, leading the agency division, and supporting marine terminal development. Since 2025, consulting on terminal acquisitions, supply chains, and maritime data and reporting, including through OceanDatum.ai; now Project Manager at Blue Water Shipping in New Orleans. Experience spans grain, coal, petcoke, chemical, liquid bulk, breakbulk, Ro-Ro, and passenger trades.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Ship Agency Operations
- Acquisition Integration
- Marine Terminal Development
- Market & Cost Modeling
- Supply Chain Modeling
- AI Integration & Development
- ERP / CRM Implementation
- Geospatial & Data Analysis

CAREER

BLUE WATER SHIPPING

Project Manager

New Orleans, LA

August 2026 – Present

- Projects spanning administrative, technology, and commercial functions

OCEANDATUM.AI

Principal

Chesapeake, VA

2026 – Present

- Independent consultancy producing port, marine terminal, and commodity market reporting from public trade, vessel, and regulatory data
- Designs and implements data and AI tools for maritime operations

SESCO CEMENT

Supply Chain Consultant

Houston, TX

May 2025 – March 2026

- Evaluated marine terminal acquisition opportunities
- Optimized rail and ocean supply chains

HOST (T. Parker Host, Inc. until 2015)

Ship agency and marine terminal roles

U.S. Atlantic & Gulf Coasts

May 2006 – May 2025

- 2006 – 2016 Ship agency acquisitions, integration, and expansion
- 2016 – 2025 Marine terminal business development, Norfolk, VA
- 2018 – 2022 Head of Agency, concurrent with the terminal role
- 2022 – 2025 Cross-department projects across agency and terminals

Titles held: Agent; Operations Manager; Vice President, Amelia Maritime Services; Regional Manager, Gulf East; Regional Manager, Gulf West; Vice President, Business Development; Head of Agency.

BARWIL / WILHELMSSEN SHIP SERVICES

Operations / Business Development

Norfolk, VA & New Orleans, LA

October 1999 – May 2006

T. PARKER HOST, INC.

Port Agent

Baltimore, MD & Norfolk, VA

November 1995 – June 1999

UNITED STATES ARMY

Infantryman, 101st Airborne Division

Fort Campbell, KY

September 1992 – June 1995

- Long-range surveillance unit; honorable discharge

EXPERIENCE AT HOST

SHIP AGENCY: ACQUISITIONS AND EXPANSION

- Integrated three agency businesses into Host: Amelia Maritime Services (Fernandina Beach and Jacksonville), a Savannah agency, and a Gulf Coast agency with offices in Mobile, New Orleans, and Houston
- Ground lead for opening new Gulf Coast offices at Sabine River and Corpus Christi

MARINE TERMINAL DEVELOPMENT

- Senior analyst within business development on three large marine terminal projects: Avondale, Louisiana (primary focus); Tradepoint, Baltimore, Maryland; and United Bulk, Davant, Louisiana, where market modeling and research supported Host's purchase of the terminal
- Contributed to roughly a dozen additional terminal proposals that did not proceed
- Due diligence, market studies, cost and supply chain modeling, permit research, and pitch books

HEAD OF AGENCY *October 2018 – February 2022*

- Led an agency division of 15 offices, 110+ staff, and about 4,200 port calls a year, New York to Brownsville, Texas; member of the executive committee
- Led the division through COVID-19 without losing a customer

CROSS-DEPARTMENT WORK

- Covered operational, financial, and staffing needs across the agency and terminal businesses through the company's growth and leadership transitions

SYSTEMS

- NetSuite ERP and CRM rollout replacing legacy systems; geospatial vessel-tracking and analytics tools; KYC due-diligence platform for compliance

EARLIER CAREER

BARWIL / WILHELMSSEN SHIP SERVICES *1999 – 2006*

- Agency operations on the Lower Mississippi River across grain, coal, chemical, refining, midstream, general cargo, and passenger terminals
- Part of the on-ground team that kept vessel operations running during and after Hurricane Katrina (2005)
- Helped open operations at Hampton Roads, Baltimore, and North Carolina ports
- Early adopter of photos and maps in proformas and berth sheets

T. PARKER HOST, PORT AGENT *1995 – 1999*

- Port calls in Baltimore, the Delaware River, and Hampton Roads: export coal, liner, Ro-Ro, and passenger vessels
- Worked with stevedores, terminal operators, customs officials, and masters; disbursement accounting and proformas

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Diploma in Ship Agency — ASBA (2021)	Maritime Transportation of Chemicals & LPG — Tank Assist BV (2015)
Arbitration in the SDNY — Society of Maritime Arbitrators (2021)	Leadership Development Program — Center for Creative Leadership (2013)
Maritime Law Certification — ASBA (2017)	ICS-408 Planning of Port Committees — USCG (2009)
Commercial Trade Transactions — ASBA (2016)	First Colonial High School, Virginia Beach, VA (1992)
Basic Principles of Chartering — ASBA (2014)	

ASSOCIATIONS & REPRESENTATION

TRADE ASSOCIATIONS & EVENTS: Connecticut Maritime Association; Society of Maritime Arbitrators; Association of Ship Brokers and Agents; Propeller Club of the United States; Virginia Maritime Association; Mississippi Valley Trade & Transport Council; West Gulf Maritime Association; Greater Houston Port Bureau; Louisiana Maritime Association; New Orleans Board of Trade; North American Export Grain Association; National Association of Steel Pipe Distributors; Inland Rivers Ports & Terminals; Southeast Fertilizer Association; US Industrial Pellet Association; Jacobs and Argus Petcoke Conferences; Breakbulk Americas; Danish Shipbrokers Week.

REGULATORY & PORT REPRESENTATION: U.S. Coast Guard; U.S. Customs & Border Protection; CBP Plant Protection & Quarantine; USDA Federal Grain Inspection Service; U.S. Army Corps of Engineers; Centers for Disease Control & Prevention; public port authorities and pilot associations.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

WRITING: Articles on maritime policy, technology, and trade at oceandatum.ai.

INTERESTS: Learning and developing AI-driven products; collecting maritime books on chartering, maritime law, port, vessel, and cargo operations, and port history (362-title bibliography); wood turning; vintage machining; live music.